Set Two:

Instructions: Welcome to your experiment! You will read some passages and answer some reading comprehension questions about them. Press SPACE to continue.

Mind wandering is a term used to describe what occurs when your attention wanders from a task. Sometimes when your mind wanders, you begin thinking about personal events or concerns rather than your task. At other times, your mind can wander because you are bored or tired and you don't really know what you're thinking about; all you know is that you are no longer thinking about your task. Press SPACE to continue.

To ensure accuracy, please read each passage carefully.

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Elizabeth Barrett was wise enough to see that Browning was a fine poet.

The young man with the lemon-colored gloves and long dark hair and high-strung, restless manner who had visited her in 1846 had been moved to write to her because she had praised his poetry.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

She found the man even more to her liking than the verse, and it was not so very long-only the time between May, 1845 and September, 1846-before Robert Browning had stolen the poetess from the dour father who guarded her like a dragon (never wanting her to marry any man), and taken her with him to Italy and a new life.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

One morning, soon after Robert and Elizabeth married; she thrust a manuscript into Robert's pocket.

Then she ran up to her room, embarrassed by her action.

The manuscript was a sonnet sequence that she had written about their courtship and their love letters.

Mrs. Browning never intended for these poems to be published, but Robert promptly insisted that they must be.

He suggested calling them Sonnets from the Portuguese.

He may have suggested this title to hide the fact that the poems were personal.

He thought that these poems were "the finest sonnets written in our language since Shakespeare's."

Robert Browning’s opinion of Sonnets from the Portuguese was flattering to his wife, the same as his opinion of most of her poetry.

He thought that she was a better poet than he was, and the world at that time agreed with him.

He called her his “moon of poets,” and she considered him her sun.

Elizabeth Barrett Browning was a pure singer with a lovely lyrical tenderness.

She was the best poet of her sex since Sappho.

Her Sonnets reveal a woman’s secret soul like no other poetry in our literature up to that time.

They did so with autobiographical honesty, fine moderation and fullness.

Her lyrical mastery shines in many passages of her writings.

Italy was a kind of promised land for Elizabeth Browning.

In the summer, she and her husband lived in Florence or in little villages.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

She drank in the sun of the south and the warmth of her husband’s love.

She blossomed in a life of delicate happiness for fifteen years.

She found friends in Italy, most of them cultured Americans.

Hawthorne saw the Browning's there: the New England thinker and essayist Margaret Fuller visited them.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

The painter Story and the young sculptress Harriet Hosmer came.

One caller records that Robert Browning was “simple, natural, and playful,” and that Mrs. Browning was all “genius and sensibility.”

Daytimes Browning walked forth with Elizabeth's little dog Flush, but he seldom could be lured from his home evenings.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

One privileged intruder, coming frequently at night to join the poets over hot chestnuts and mulled wine, found talk good and laughter plentiful.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

He found the talk good and the laughter plentiful.

The Brownings had a son, Robert Weidemann Browning, during the third year of their stay in Italy.

But a strain of dark dread began to creep through this happy life.

Elizabeth Browning's father died still disapproving of her marriage.

He had refused to see her or to allow any of his family to see her.

Elizabeth's dearly loved sister died and left three children who were all younger than her own boy.

Elizabeth drooped and grieved a little and Robert shielded her from ordinary visitors.

She had a sudden and alarming attack of sickness but was not considered in any danger.

One night, soon after, she awoke from a troubled sleep, apparently with no idea that she was about to leave Robert.

She spoke tenderly about her love for him. In his arms, her head drooped as though in a faint, but it was the end.

Profound and lasting was Browning's grief. "Looking back," he said, "I see that we have been all the time walking over a torrent on a straw."

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. Flush was the name of the Brownings'

a. cat.

b. dog

c. canary

d. turtle

e. thrush

2. At night the Brownings often enjoyed

a. hot chestnuts

b. a tart with clotted cream

c. strawberries and cream

d. café au lait

e. cheese soufflé

3. The Brownings saw

a. Coleridge

b. Byron

c. Walt Whitman

d. Poe

e. Hawthrone

4. Browning wrote to Miss Barrett because she had

a. invited him to visit

b. written him for advice

c. praised his poetry

d. sent him one of her own poems

e. sent a friend to meet him

5. The authors of this passage placed most attention on the Brownings'

a. literary efforts

b. personal relationship

c. social contacts

d. problems

e. early meeting

6. What best describes the Brownings' early days abroad?

a. travel

b. relaxation

c. creative activity

d. intellectual stimulation

e. happiness

7. You would assume that Browning

a. found it easy to see Elizabeth

b. carefully avoided Mr. Barrett

c. begged Mr. Barrett's consent to marry

d. understood Mr. Barrett

e. got Elizabeth to ask her father's consent

8. In the "torrent on a straw" quotation, the word straw probably refers to

a. the frailty of life

b. weakness of character

c. sorrow

d. happiness

e. the fleeting nature of fame

The performance of those business activities that direct the flow of goods and services from producer to consumer or user is called marketing.

Marketing is the connecting link between the producer and the consumer or user.

Production and consumption are brought together by the marketing system.

Wholesaling or retailing activities are directly engaged in by approximately one in every six gainfully employed persons.

This ratio does not take into account other persons who are serving marketing through transportation, communication, and office vocations.

Opportunities for many kinds of positions requiring a wide range of skills and abilities is provided by marketing.

Although one naturally thinks of merchandising as being the primary occupation in marketing, there are opportunities in management, advertising, market and product research, and purchasing.

The economic well-being of one's country is determined largely by productivity, consumption, and employment.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

All three are affected by the efficiency of the marketing process.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

If marketing stimulates appetite, people will consume goods at a high rate.

High consumption requires high productivity to meet the requirements of people, and high productivity and high-level activity in marketing combined result in high employment.

Indirectly, marketing is a key to a high level of economic living for the people.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. Our economic well-being is determined largely by how many factors?

a. one

b. two

c. three

d. four

e. five

2. One major factor mentioned as affecting our economic well-being was

a. high wages

b. low interest rates

c. technology

d. employment

e. foreign trade

3. The purpose of this passage is to

a. persuade

b. guide

c. evaluate

d. inform

e. interest

4. The chief emphasis is on

a. defining marketing

b. principles of marketing

c. opportunities in marketing

d. kinds of jobs in marketing

e. the economic significance of marketing

The nucleus of an atom is held together by a kind of energy called atomic energy.

The sun's energy comes from atomic reactions.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

These reactions occur when the nuclei of hydrogen build up the nuclei of helium.

An atomic nucleus is made of particles, but the mass of the atomic nucleus is less than the total mass of the particles.

The reason for this is that part of the mass of particles is changed into energy when a nucleus is formed.

This energy then radiates away.

The quantity of energy released in reactions of this kind is almost inconceivably greater than the quantity released by any other type of reaction involving similar quantities of material.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

Every second, the sun sends a million times more energy into space than we have stored in all of our coal, petroleum, and natural gas fields.

We could revolutionize the world if we could duplicate the method that releases such energy.

This possibility is not a fantasy, just as it was not a fantasy to imagine developing an atom bomb in 1900.

The time may come when the hydrogen from a cubic mile of sea water will provide enough energy to satisfy our needs at the 1960 rate for 300 centuries.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. How much sea water was mentioned?

a. One ton

b. A cubic acre

c. A cubic mile

d. A thousand gallons

e. A hundred tons

2. The quantity of energy released in an atomic reaction is spoken of as how much greater than with other types of reactions?

a. Far greater

b. Unbelievably greater

c. A thousand times greater

d. Inconceivably greater

e. Tremendously greater

3. The primary focus is on

a. how energy is released

b. where energy is found

c. the energy from atomic reactions

d. what happens in atomic reactions

e. the energy present in sunshine

4. This passage is best described as

a. objective

b. skeptical

c. cautious

d. conservative

e. optimistic

Even most skeptics, because they seem to share the hope that there is life on Mars, endeavor slavishly not to discount the possibility.

But it was a comedown in the mid-1960's when scientists involved in the Mars exploration studied photographs taken by some of the early Mariner space flights.

No canals.

No seas.

No busy Martian engineers.

No menacing warmongering Martians as colossal as skyscrapers.

Just mountains, craters, frigid winds, and dust storms.

It was almost as if scouts for Columbus had returned to Isabella's court with the news that the world had turned out to be flat after all.

Hopeful astronomers reminded us that the Mariner IV had photographed a mere one percent of the Martian surface from 2,000 miles away.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

And they pointed out that the Earth-orbiting Tiros weather satellite shot over 20,000 pictures before uncovering any evidence of life on Earth.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

But still, public enthusiasm for Martian exploration wilted.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

By the time Viking I touched down on the Plain of Chryse in August, few seemed to care at all.

J. Richard Keefe, one of the Viking scientists, declared himself "disgusted" at what he called the "blasé…apathetic" public response and the skimpy television coverage of what was certainly one of the magnificent scientific and technical accomplishments in human history.

1. One weather satellite was named

a. Latos

b. Tiros

c. Prometheus

d. Sonar

e. Satelos

2. One of the Mariners photographed how much of the surface of Mars?

a. One percent

b. Two percent

c. Three percent

d. Four percent

e. Five percent

3. Interest in Mars diminished largely because

a. no Martians were found

b. the TV coverage was poor

c. the photos were all black and white

d. nothing was brought back to earth

e. the media did not appreciate the accomplishment

4. Mention of the flat world was used to point up

a. the flatness of Mars

b. the lack of canals

c. the lack of seas

d. the lack of Martians

e. the lack of mountains

Fungi give cheese the flavor, odor, and character that gourmets so highly prize.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

One of the first molds was found in caves near the French village of Roquefort.

According to legend, a peasant boy left his lunch, which was a mild fresh piece of goat cheese, in one of the caves.

When he returned, he found the cheese marbled, tart, and fragrant.

Only cheeses that come from the area around these particular caves are allowed to bear the name of Roquefort.

As early as the seventeenth century, ergot, the fungus of rye, was used to facilitate childbirth.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

It causes the contraction of involuntary muscles, particularly in the uterus.

In the twentieth century, ergot has once more attracted interest as the source of the chemical from which the hallucinogenic drug LSD is derived

Most modern antibiotics are produced by fungi.

Alexander Fleming discovered the first of these antibiotics.

A mold of the genus Penicillium had contaminated a culture of staphylococcus bacteria that was growing on a nutrient agar plate.

Alexander noted that the mold completely halted the growth of the bacteria.

Antibiotics, of which many hundreds have now been discovered, are substances produced by a living organism that injure another living organism.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

All of these are substances produced by one living organism that injures another living organism.

1. A fungus was used as medicine as early as what century?

a. Sixteenth

b. Seventeenth

c. Eighteenth

d. Nineteenth

e. Twentieth

2. How many antibiotics have been discovered?

a. Ninety-six

b. Many hundreds

c. Thousands

d. Millions

e. An unspecified number

3. This passage is mainly about

a. ergot

b. drugs

c. fungi

d. antibiotics

e. cheese

4. LSD is specifically mentioned to show that ergot

a. needs to be further controlled

b. needs further research

c. has medicinal value

d. is of current interest

e. is dangerous

Local governments were our first governments.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

The primitive tribe that chose the strongest man to be its chief and the oldest men to form a council was establishing local government.

It was seeking a better, safer life.

In the same way, the need for rules and leaders was realized by the first English settlers who landed at Jamestown, Virginia, in 1607.

At first, the settlers at Jamestown had to shepherd themselves.

The colonists searched for gold, and had to find their own sustenance and provide their own sanctuary.

As food supplies began to run low, and as the colonists faced hunger and disease, they saw that they needed to work together if the colony was to survive.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

A council to make laws for the colony was formed by the settlers.

Captain John Smith was chosen as president of the council to see that the laws were implemented.

This government at Jamestown was the first local government in America.

Today, local government is still the first and most important government in our lives.

It protects our lives, our safety, and our homes, and it helps to keep our environment clean.

Schools, libraries, and other important services are provided to us by local government.

1. The first colonial government was

a. tribal

b. city

c. county

d. local

e. federal

2. The Jamestown colonists formed a government because of

a. pride

b. greed

c. necessity

d. togetherness

e. public spirit

3. The best title for this selection would be

a. John Smith

b. The First Government

c. Jamestown

d. Local Government

e. American Government

4. The overall goal of local government seems to be public

a. regulation

b. wealth

c. growth

d. welfare

e. protection

Once in a while you will hear about an artist who was recognized as a master during his lifetime, but was then almost forgotten after his death.

A good example is the painter, Domenicos Theotocopoulos.

He was known as El Greco because of his Greek ancestry.

After pursuing his early career in Italy, El Greco settled in the Spanish city of Toledo, where he prospered for the rest of his life.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

He prospered there for the rest of his life.

History forgot El Greco for nearly three hundred years.

Then, artists and critics of the twentieth century rediscovered him.

The power of El Greco's intensely emotional style can be felt most strongly in his later paintings, such as the famous View of Toledo.

He painted this canvas in 1610, only a few years before his death.

It is a strange landscape.

One notices that eerie, silvery buildings take on a ghostlike stillness next to the explosive light of the sky and the writhing forms of the countryside below.

Curiously, about the same time, another important artist was scorned even by many of his contemporaries.

This artist was Caravaggio.

He was a self-taught painter who came to Rome around 1590 from a small town in Lombardy.

Caravaggio's critics complained that he treated sacred religious subjects in a low, vulgar way by including the faces and figures of common people in his paintings.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

By using stark contrasts of light and shadow, Caravaggio managed to conjure up unforgettable scenes of dramatic realism.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. In his paintings, Caravaggio included

a. common people

b. strange landscapes

c. eerie, silvery buildings

d. ghosts

e. corpses

2. El Greco pursued his early career in

a. Italy

b. Greece

c. Lombardy

d. Rome

e. Toledo

3. Apparently a major technique of Caravaggio's was

a. using exalted religious subjects

b. using stark contrasts

c. using cadavers

d. using ghostlike stillness

e. none of the above

4. The principal idea discussed in this passage concerns

a. El Greco

b. Caravaggio

c. contemporary approval of artists

d. the travels of painters

e. the prosperity of artists

The key to the design called experimental is assignment of subjects to conditions randomly.

By the influence on the results of some extraneous variable that is tied to or correlated with the variable under investigation is insured against.

By contrast with experimental designs, subjects, in correlational designs, in a sense, assign themselves to conditions.

Thus, in the cancer studies as they have been done, only people who are four-pack-a-day smokers—by their own "choice"—get into a four-pack-a-day condition.

Whatever the factors are that contribute to a person's being a heavy smoker surely must also make him different from the typical nonsmoker in other ways.

Hence the ambiguity of interpretation in correlational designs, and hence the virtue of experimental designs.

In the latter case, if assignment to conditions is truly random then prevailing differences among individual subjects cannot confound the results systematically.

Put another way, the experimenter has under his control all the variables that can influence the results.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

Whether he can exactly identify these variables is another question.

Thus, entirely unambiguous results are not yielded by experimental designs, merely results that are less ambiguous than those associated with correlational designs.

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence? PRESS q FOR YES. PRESS p FOR NO.

1. Specific mention is made of

a. psychogenesis

b. psychodynamics

c. psychobiology

d. psychotherapy

e. none of the above

2. How many research design patterns were discussed?

a. only one

b. two

c. three

d. four

e. five

3. As used in this passage, the phrase “put another way” means

a. rephrasing

b. enumeration

c. using details

d. reasoning

e. illustration

4. In this passage the authors imply that heavy smoking is probably caused by

a. tension

b. nervousness

c. habit

d. social pressure

e. all the above and more

You will now complete part 2 of the study